



Cracking the IT Interview —FAQ

This introductory chapter from the book 'Cracking the C, C++ and Java Interview' is in the form of Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ). It answers many of the basic doubts most students and young programmers have. These FAQ also clear a few misconceptions about attending interviews.

General questions

1 What skills do IT companies look for in prospective candidates?

IT companies look out for various technical skills and soft skills in candidates. In soft skills, communication skills are very important. Other soft skills include presentation skills, team-work, writing skills, etc. In technical skills, companies expect the candidates to have good expertise in their area of graduation. For computer science students, evergreen technical skills are C, Unix, operating systems and networking. Candidates with these skills are likely to have better chances of getting a job.

2 When should I start preparing for placements?

For soft skills, it is better to start preparing one year before the placements start. For technical skills, it is beneficial to focus from the first year itself. Otherwise, you can start revising important subjects—from the placements point of view—from one year before placements.

3 What is the difference between a CV and a résumé?

A CV (Curriculum Vitae) is a document prepared by a student or a fresher searching for a job. It provides the academic details of the student. A résumé is prepared by a person having work experience, which emphasises job history and on-the-job skills and experience.